A

2025年度学力試験問題

教　科　名

英　　語

2025年2月25日

9時50分から

11時30分まで

注　意　事　項

1. 英語の問題は2ページから14ページまでである。
2. 解答はすべて解答用紙の指定された箇所に書くこと。
3. 解答用紙は3枚(その一，その二，その三)である。

問題 1 *Read the text and comments below and write QUESTIONS in English for the answers below.* (30 点)

A young English teacher from the UK is in her first teaching job in a language school in Thailand. On her first day at school, she enters her classroom to find 25 students. The maximum class size is supposed to be 15, and they do not really all fit in the room; it is very crowded, making classroom activities difficult. She teaches the class, but as soon as it is finished, she goes to see the manager of the school, who is Thai. She explains the situation to the manager and the problems caused by the excess of students. Throughout this, the manager listens with a smile on his face, saying nothing. At the end of the teacher's explanation, the manager grins, but says nothing, and walks away. The young teacher is now rather confused and upset. The manager appears not to be taking her problem seriously. He did not acknowledge her problem or make any offer to remedy it. In fact, the teacher thinks his response was quite dismissive and the grin and smile on the manager's face made this impression for him stronger.

The next day, with some reluctance, the teacher returns to the class. However, on entering the class, she is surprised to find 15 students there and the correct table and chair arrangements. A new class has been started in the next room with the other 10 students. All of the teacher's concerns from the previous day have been resolved. She became rather confused. Later, another teacher explains that a smile and a grin is a very normal response to a problem for many Thai people, not a sign of dismissiveness. Moreover, listening in silence is also a normal communicative response when someone is complaining. The English teacher has just learned an important lesson in communication. If she is going to get along as an English teacher in Thailand, she must adjust her expectations of how communication goes on and should not assume the sort of responses she is familiar with from the UK.

Comments

You might think this is an example of miscommunication. The British teacher and the Thai manager have different expectations about communication, which leads to misunderstanding on the part of the teacher. However, even if not completely successful, the communication is actually reasonably successful. The teacher's concerns were clearly understood and dealt with by the manager. We should also consider that their identities as teacher, employee, and manager are as relevant as being British or Thai. Language issues are also important. The manager's speaking ability in English is not particularly high, and this may have influenced his responses. The employee has almost no ability to communicate in Thai. If the communication had been in Thai, it might have been very different.

Answers

(1) 10 extra students.

(2) Because the room is very crowded.

(3) She goes to see the manager.

(4) A new class on the following day.

(5) Another teacher at the language school.

(6) Reasonably successful.

問題 2 *Read the text below and answer the questions in English.* (40 点)

I was invited recently to visit the country house of a fellow American here in Japan. His house is in an upscale neighborhood of Ainosato, an area where the Sapporo elite escape on the weekends. To get there, my trip would require a one hour walk to the subway, twenty minutes up to Sapporo Station, a forty-minute train ride out of the city, and then my host would pick me up and drive me the remaining five miles to his house. For someone who normally drives everywhere, this was more like a travel experience visiting some obscure attraction in a foreign land.

Now, when I travel, I usually keep to myself. As a result of my fair skin and light hair color, I can travel much of the northern hemisphere and blend right in. But, not in Japan. Here, I get noticed and sometimes people want to practice their English with me. So here, whether on a bus, train, or plane, I put on my earphones and gaze out at whatever scenery is available.

On this occasion, the walk to the subway was no problem. It was a beautiful day and the wind was cool. It was Sunday and that usually means crowds. But, the subway was largely empty, only getting busy at the last few stations before Sapporo Station, in the center of the city.

I did not have a particular train departure in mind when I got to Sapporo Station. I knew the train I wanted, on the Gakuentoshi line, runs from platform 11. I checked that ahead of time. I looked up at the timetable and noticed the next departure was at 12 pm, in two minutes. And if I didn't catch that one, I'd have to wait 25 minutes for the next one. I tapped my pass to enter the station and ran for the platform. Being a large person by Japanese standards, I felt a bit like Godzilla terrorizing Tokyo in the movies, with people moving aside as I ran past. I had to go up three flights of stairs, through the descending passengers who'd just arrived, and jumped into the train just as the doors were closing. I didn't enjoy doing that.

The train was fairly full when I entered and there were no empty rows, so I stood at the end of the carriage, hoping that at Soen, the first stop in three minutes, a couple passengers would get off and I could grab a seat in that small bit of time before the next passengers got on. And that is exactly what happened. At the first stop, a couple people got up from a row on the right side, in the middle of the carriage, and got off. I quickly grabbed the window seat on the right side. I replaced my earphones which I had taken off to run to the train, started my music, and let out a sigh of relief. The train pushed forward, and continued its journey out of the city out into the countryside. All was well, until ...

About six stations in, on what would be about a ten station trip out to Ainosato, I noticed the man in the row in front of me turn his head around and look at me. When he saw me shift my eyes from the passing countryside toward him, he turned his head back. Now, this is not that uncommon for me in Japan. But, it is uncomfortable. When he turned back to facing forward, I returned to staring out the window. About two minutes later, he turned his head back again and said to me in English, "Where are you from?" I had my earphones in. I took them off and he asked again in English, "Where are you from?" With no smile, or change in my facial expression, I simply answered, "Sapporo." His face changed, the smile gone, and he paused, looking completely unsatisfied in my answer and looking like he expected me to say more. I did not. Then he said to me in Japanese, "So you speak Japanese." My answer was simple. "Yes, I do." He then turned back to facing forward and that was the end of our conversation. I exited the train at Ainosato, a couple stops later, and did not look back at him.

The famous artist Georgia O'Keeffe once said "Where I was born and where and how I live is unimportant. It is what I have done with where I have been that should be of interest." But, in Japan, not being Japanese, the only thing most people are interested in is where I was born. They assume I

am a tourist, even traveling alone on a local train heading into the countryside. I have lived in Sapporo for almost three decades, more than where I grew up. I have written and published books and articles, poems and short stories. I have spoken at universities all over the world and have traveled to many countries. I am a doctor and a professor. I speak three languages. But here, in Japan, the only thing I am ever asked is "Where are you from?" And when I answer honestly, I am looked at as if they heard me wrong. Sometimes they even repeat the question with an added word or two "So, where are you really from?" I think you already know the answer I give.

The earphones serve a purpose, even when I have the music off.

Questions

(1) In sentence one, the writer mentions going to see a "fellow American." What does this phrase mean? (3点)

(2) At the beginning of the story, the writer mentions that he is going to an "upscale neighborhood." What does this mean? (3点)

(3) In paragraph two, the writer mentions that usually in the northern hemisphere he can "blend right in." What does this phrase mean? (3点)

(4) In paragraph four, why did the writer feel a bit like Godzilla? Explain in two sentences. (3点)

(5) In paragraph five, why did the writer let out a sigh of relief? (3点)

(6) In paragraph six, why did the other passenger look "completely unsatisfied" by the writer's answer? In two sentences, explain. (5点)

(7) Near the end of the story, the writer quotes Georgia O'Keeffe. In two sentences, explain what the writer is trying to say by using this quotation. (5点)

(8) In the final line of the next to last paragraph, the writer says, "I think you already know the answer I give." What answer is that? (5点)

(9) In the context of this story, what does the writer mean when he says "The earphones serve a purpose, even when I have the music off." (5点)

(10) In two sentences, summarize the main purpose for the man telling his story. (5点)

問題 3 *Read the text below and answer the questions in English.* (40 点)

Almost six years ago, when I became a parent, one of my very few certainties was that I would read to my daughter. I had been an only child, and now I was raising one. I wanted my daughter to learn, as I had, that stories were sources of adventure, inspiration and constant, loyal companionship.

So I read to my daughter the way I had been read to, diversely but faithfully. As she got older, we talked about the exploits of Frog and Toad, and Junie B. Jones, and the Pevensies almost as often as we talked about her friends from school. As soon as she could write the letters of her name, she got her own library card and (a) started to add her selections to the pile. And last year, when we started to read J. R. R. Tolkien's novel *The Hobbit* (1937) together, she listened patiently to the first two chapters. Then she told me, unemotionally, that Bilbo Baggins was a girl.

Well, I said. That would be nice. But Bilbo is definitely a boy.

No, she said. Bilbo is a girl.

I hesitated. I wanted to share the story I knew, and I had always known Bilbo as a boy. But it seemed that my daughter knew otherwise. I soon agreed to swap 'he' with 'she' and 'his' with 'her', and my daughter and I met Girl Bilbo — who turned out to be a delightful heroine. She was humble and resourceful and witty and brave. She wasn't merely a superficial Strong Female Character with little to do, but a true heroine with her very own quest and skills. For my daughter, Girl Bilbo was thrilling. For me, she was damn refreshing.

When I wrote about this experiment in literary gender-swapping for the Last Word On Nothing website last year, the public response to Girl Bilbo was startling. My daughter had 'brought the internet's Tolkien fanboys to their Mithril-padded knees', in the words of one commenter. Girl Bilbo and her

implications, I knew through comments and emails, were discussed at length in science-fiction circles, parenting groups, Head Start classes, and among Swedish devotees of role-playing games.

While many of these readers were enthusiastic about my daughter's idea, a sizable minority thought I was considering unorthodox ideas. (b) Leave the classics alone, they said. If you want stories with more female characters, some suggested, write them yourself. But my daughter didn't create Girl Bilbo, and neither did I. She has deep roots, and she isn't going away anytime soon.

As a parent, literary genderswapping — and other kinds of narrative reinvention — have made it possible to share some of my very favorite stories with my daughter. Sure, I could try my hand at writing new books with female characters, as some of my critics have suggested, but my efforts could never replace those of Lloyd Alexander, or Mark Twain, or any of the other geniuses that wrote so well for children of other generations. Though they wrote in times when it was difficult to imagine central roles for girls, their stories still deserve telling, and genderswapping allows us to do so with all the joy and none of (c) the old-fashioned stereotypes. Since my daughter and I read *The Hobbit*, we've swapped many characters in many classic children's books. My daughter knows the originals are different — I'm a firm believer in full-disclosure remixing — and some day, I hope, she'll read and treasure those books herself. But when she does, she'll know an alternative version is possible, too.

For me, the most fascinating part of literary genderswapping is its illumination of my own assumptions. Not long ago, my daughter and I read an Ursula K. Le Guin novel with a young male hero. When we switched the pronouns, I found myself pleasantly but repeatedly surprised by our heroine's independence. She journeyed alone, building her own boats, casting her own spells, and passing tests of strength and wits as she confronted dragons and

shadows.

Of course she can do that, I thought. Of course she should be able to. But I was raised on Boy Bilbo, and on a million other stories where boys — usually white, usually English-speaking, usually straight — assume the lead. If I wrote a girl-centric adventure story for my daughter, I might reflexively throw in a male companion, or put our heroine on an easier path. By switching pronouns, though, my daughter and I met a heroine who pushed the boundaries of both our imaginations and took us on a truly unexpected journey.

Frog and Toad, Junie B. Jones, the Pevensies: well-known characters in children's books

Mithril: a fictional metal in J. R. R. Tolkien's novels

Lloyd Alexander, Mark Twain, Ursula K. Le Guin: famous American writers

Questions

(1) Find a word in the passage that has the same meaning as 'to face'.

(2) What was one of the author's primary intentions in reading to her daughter?

(3) Explain the meaning of phrase (a).

(4) Why did the author initially hesitate when her daughter suggested that Bilbo Baggins was a girl?

(5) Why did the author agree to swap the gender pronouns for Bilbo Baggins?

(6) Explain in your own word the meaning of sentence (b).

(7) Given the context, explain the meaning of phrase (c).

(8) Why did the author find herself repeatedly surprised by the heroine's independence?

問題 4 *Below is a conversation between a Japanese girl and her British friend living in London. Fill in the blanks with appropriate English responses.* (40 点)

At the London Heathrow Airport

Hanako: Hello, Kate!

Kate: Hi! Welcome to the UK, Hanako!

Hanako: It's great to be here at last.

Kate: I know you've (1) _____, right?

Hanako: Yes, it's been my dream since elementary school.

Kate: OK, let's get your bags.

Hanako: Wow, Heathrow Airport is (2) _____!

Kate: It's actually the third busiest airport in the world, with 5 terminals.

Hanako: That's interesting! Now (3) _____?

Kate: I suggest catching the Heathrow Express. It's the fastest way and takes only 15 minutes.

Hanako: Fine. I can't wait to explore Britain.

Kate: That's what (4) _____, so let's start!

The next day in central London

Kate: We've seen so many amazing sights this morning.

Hanako: Yeah, but now (5) _____, because my feet are killing me.

Kate: Me too. Look, there's a pub just across the street. (6) _____?

Hanako: Wait ... a pub? (7) _____?

Kate: Don't worry. Most pubs serve not only alcohol but also soft drinks

and tasty foods nowadays. They serve even tea and coffee.

Hanako: Really? In that case, it sounds perfect. So, let's have some lunch there!

In the afternoon, outside the pub

Hanako: Oh no! It's raining cats and dogs.

Kate: That's alright. (8) _____ in London. We haven't been to any of London's famous museums yet.

Hanako: True. But today is Sunday. (9) _____?

Kate: The good news is that almost all museums are open seven days a week. And the even better news is that most of them are free.

Hanako: You're kidding, aren't you?

Kate: Haha, absolutely not!

Hanako: (10) _____.

Kate: Yeah, I agree. Now let's go to the British Museum first!

問題 5 *Write short essays in English for BOTH part* (a) *and part* (b) *below.* (50 点)

(a) This is an advice column of a newspaper. If you were Alice, how would you advise the following concerns? Write your advice in about 80 words.

Otaru Evening News

25/02/2025

Ask Alice Advice Column

Dear Alice,

Q. I am an engineer, but I don't like my job. My boss is always angry, and there are always too many things to do. I don't feel like going to work in the morning, especially on Monday. What should I do?

A. _____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

(b) Look at the cartoon below and then write a short story about the family's experience yesterday. (about 80 words)